

STONEX GLOBAL

Q+A

Stories to Tell

With a lit fest to his name now and several new books hitting the market on his 92nd birthday, ***Ruskin Bond*** *is in no mood to retire*

Q. What do you think the Ruskin Bond Festival can achieve?

Siddharth, my grandson, has made it his mission to extend my literary legacy. He has started the Ruskin Bond Foundation with a few friends, and they've already been involved in some events. This is the first time they've put on a show for me, supported by StoneX Global. I continue to work in spite of my poor eyesight, thanks to my granddaughter Shrishti who very sweetly takes my dictation.

Q. Is there a book you really wanted to write, but never got round to?

Not really, because I've been writing for 75 years from the age of 16. At that age, maybe I wanted to write a big novel, but I realised that my talents were more suited to the shorter versions of fiction—the short story or even a novella. I've always worked within my limits and never felt that I should have written a big fat novel. I don't even read big fat novels.

Q. At 92, do you feel age is just a number?

In a way, yes. Physically, I'm not going to take part in the Olympics. Apart from the necessity to learn to walk post-surgery, I'm in reasonably good health. Apart from the last couple of years when my health deteriorated, I have always felt the same age since I was 16.

Q. What life lessons can you share with our readers?

Don't give up easily. Hold on to your dreams. Realise that the road ahead is not an easy one, but you must navigate it in as sensible a way as possible. And help others as much as you can.

—with Amit Dixit